

Philipp Hilbert. *Founding product operator who ships AI-native software.*

Positioning, product manager with ten years building complex operational software, ready to own PlanD's AI-ERP roadmap from discovery through rollout.

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§ WHY PLAND

PlanD occupies an interesting position: product-market fit confirmed, 700 paying customers, a clear upmarket ambition, and a mandate to become the AI-first ERP for a 30-billion-euro market that has historically been underserved by good software. The job description explicitly names AI-native company building as a strategic priority, not a feature flag, which is exactly the operating mode I have been in for the past two years. Working directly with the founder on a roadmap with that kind of scope, inside a small team with fast decision cycles, is the structural condition where I do my best work. *That combination of clear domain focus and genuine product ambition is rare.*

§ HONEST FRAMING

I have no prior career experience specifically inside the Gebäudereinigung or Facilities Management vertical. What I do have is a decade of translating opaque, process-heavy operational workflows – defence data platforms, public-sector analytics, InsurTech underwriting, hospital information systems – into structured, shippable software. The mechanic transfers directly: talk to users, model the domain, find the constraint, ship the smallest thing that removes it.

§ AI-NATIVE STACK

Daily tools, not buzzwords.

- **Claude**, spec writing, edge-case generation, PR reviews
- **GPT**, research synthesis, user-interview analysis
- **Cursor / VS Code**, in-repo implementation and refactors
- **Claude Code**, autonomous feature delivery end-to-end
- **Lovable**, rapid front-end prototyping
- **Framer**, design-heavy flows and stakeholder demos
- **n8n**, multi-agent and automation workflow design
- **Gamma.app**, discovery decks and stakeholder documentation

§ TECHNICAL ENVIRONMENT

Shipped with, not just listed.

Kotlin with Spring Boot, Python, Django, JavaScript, PostgreSQL, MongoDB, REST APIs, Kubernetes, ArgoCD, Helm, Argo Workflows, OpenShift, Jenkins, Dagster, dbt, DuckDB, Redpanda, Docker, GitOps pipelines, CI/CD with full test integration, Bitbucket, Git.

§ SIDE PROJECT

BACKTEST ENGINE & DEV AGENT FRAMEWORK [GITHUB.COM/HILBERTP](https://github.com/hilbertp) →

Personal infrastructure for algorithmic crypto strategy research and agentic code execution.

- Builds and runs backtests for crypto trading strategies against historical market data.
- Architecture uses a file-queue-based agent loop with n8n orchestration and Python execution layers.
- Active development with iterative strategy slices; tools include Coinglass and Hyblock Capital for market microstructure analysis.
- Demonstrates the same end-to-end ownership and AI-native execution speed PlanD needs when prototyping and validating new ERP automation features fast.

§ HOW I WOULD WORK AT PLAND

First weeks, concrete.

WEEK 1

Listen, map, find the gaps.

Shadow customer support and sales calls, read every existing spec and ticket, map the current operational workflows cleaning companies actually run through PlanD, and identify the three areas where AI automation would remove the most friction today.

WEEK 2

Slice, validate, specify.

Pick the highest-confidence opportunity from week one, run two to three short customer interviews to stress-test the assumption, and produce a tight spec with acceptance criteria ready for engineering.

WEEK 3+

Ship, close loops.

Drive the first AI feature from spec to rollout, instrument the success metric, and establish the discovery-to-delivery cadence that makes this pace repeatable.

I COVER LETTER

Dear PlanD team,

The combination you are building is specific and credible: a domain-vertical ERP with genuine product-market fit, a clear path to ten million ARR, and a founder-led mandate to make AI a structural part of how the product works, not just a marketing claim. That is the kind of product problem I find most interesting, and it is the environment I have been preparing for across the last decade of product work.

My most directly relevant experience is the Rohde & Schwarz engagement: a greenfield AI data platform, government-grade complexity, a cross-functional team spanning architects, data scientists, backend and frontend engineers, and QA, and a delivery culture that rewarded autonomous execution over committee approval. I shipped autonomous feature sets end-to-end, cut deployment times from several days to under forty minutes by introducing GitOps with ArgoCD, and unblocked infrastructure issues the project lead had been waiting on engineers to solve for over a year. That pattern, seeing the gap, owning the solution, shipping it without permission, is the one I would bring to PlanD from day one.

At Emil Group I walked into a prototype-stage InsurTech platform where delivery had broken down: a bloated seventeen-person team, eroded client trust, and near-total senior developer attrition. I split the team into smaller Scrum units, reintroduced velocity tracking and structured refinement, rebuilt the weekly communication rhythm with the client, and reduced attrition to a

single departure. The domain was InsurTech; the underlying problem was operational software for a complex regulated workflow, which is structurally similar to what ERP for Gebäudereinigung demands: multi-role users, rule-heavy processes, high cost of errors, and users who are not software people.

On the AI-native side, I work daily with Claude, Claude Code, Cursor, Lovable, Framer, and n8n. I use these tools not as productivity accessories but as a core part of how I move from discovery to prototype to specification to shipped feature. I have built my own dev agent framework and a backtesting engine for crypto strategies, which means I understand agentic workflows from the inside, both as a product designer and as someone who has debugged the failure modes. That hands-on infrastructure orientation is what I would bring to PlanD's AI-first product culture.

I am a native German speaker, Berlin-based, and ready to start in July. I would welcome a conversation about how the current roadmap is structured and where you see the biggest leverage points for a first AI product hire.

Best regards, *Philipp Hilbert*

II CURRICULUM VITAE

§ BEARING

Founding Product Manager with ten years of experience turning complex operational workflows into scalable, shippable software. Background spans AI data platforms, public-sector analytics, InsurTech, and mobile healthcare, always in environments where requirements are incomplete and delivery speed matters. Fluent in AI-native execution: Claude Code, Cursor, Lovable, n8n, and rapid front-end prototyping are part of the daily working method, not aspirational tools. Comfortable owning product areas end-to-end from discovery and customer interviews through spec, sprint discipline, and GitOps rollout. Native German, EU citizen, Berlin-based.

§ CORE STRENGTHS

- Operational workflow decomposition into dev-ready requirements
- AI-native feature delivery from prototype to production
- Customer discovery and structured user interviews
- Backlog management, sprint discipline, and velocity recovery

- Cross-functional alignment across engineering, design, and stakeholders
 - Autonomous end-to-end feature ownership with no handholding
 - Rapid prototyping with Lovable and Framer
 - Technical fluency: Python, JavaScript, PostgreSQL, Kubernetes, REST APIs
 - Founder-level pragmatism: low ego, high agency, strong prioritisation
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§ PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

ROHDE & SCHWARZ 2024, 2025

Product Manager, AI Data Transformation

- Delivered autonomous feature sets end-to-end: user stories, acceptance criteria, implementation support, testing, and GitOps rollout
- Reduced deployment times from several days to 20–40 minutes by introducing GitOps with ArgoCD
- Unblocked infrastructure-level issues in OpenShift independently; delivered in one week a feature the project lead had been requesting from engineers for over a year
- Built central AI and data management platform for multimodal datasets (image, audio, tabular) within the European defence programme FCAS
- Improved data quality via filtering, tagging, reproducible transformation pipelines, and audit trails with full data provenance
- Led cross-functional team: architect, data scientists, backend and frontend engineers, QA

FEDERAL EMPLOYMENT AGENCY 2023, 2024

Product Manager, Public Data Analytics

- Introduced Dagster for automated ETL and indicator generation, replacing manual pipeline management
- Delivered labour shortage analytics, flexible regional comparison tooling, and modernised admin interfaces
- Migrated legacy systems to Kubernetes and managed major system upgrades with zero service interruption
- Standardised CI/CD with full test integration at build time
- Served as Deputy IT Security Officer with focus on compliance, governance, and data lineage

EMIL GROUP 2022

Product Manager, InsurTech SaaS Platform

- Designed and delivered a Claims Center module from concept to production rollout on a B2B InsurTech platform reducing insurance product time-to-market from over a year to under a week
- Split a bloated 17-person team into smaller, effective Scrum units; introduced ownership and deputy concepts
- Reintroduced velocity tracking and structured refinement practices that had collapsed under delivery pressure
- Regained client trust in a prototype-stage environment through structured communication and weekly product workshops
- Reduced senior developer attrition from near-total to a single departure

CLINET PLATFORMS 2021, 2022

Product Owner, Mobile Healthcare App

- Delivered core flows for digital anamnesis, meal and therapy plans, transport, chat, and patient document storage on a mobile-first iOS/Android pilot for hospitals
- Integrated CGM interface into hospital information system workflows
- Led a small team under tight deadlines with strict focus on highest-leverage features

§ FOUNDER & EARLY-STAGE EXPERIENCE

- **Qcrypt AG, Product Owner (2016–2018):** Quantum-secure encryption product built on one-time-pad keys and true-RNG hardware. Owned backup, restore, checkpoint, and data-encryption product architecture. Also served as deputy IT security officer.
- **Kvitt Payment Solutions, Founder & CFO (2013–2018):** Group-based P2P payments on a P2P backbone. PSP integration, full UX/UI design, mobile app prototype. Later acquired and operated by Sparkasse.
- **AOK ITSCare, Proxy Product Owner (2019–2020):** Migration of internal webshop to Shopware, including complex catalogue and API integration and customisable approval policies.
- **Bundesdruckerei / RKI, Product Owner (2021):** COVID-19 data platform projects DIM and DESH. Secure data structures and identity management.
- **Smart Soil Technologies, Co-Founder / CDO / CFO (2016–2021):** Intelligent self-regulation fertiliser and substrate solutions for vertical indoor farming. Full digital tooling establishment, financial and investment planning, ERP introduction.

§ LANGUAGES

German, native. English, C2.

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